

Project Health Evaluation Rubric

Revision: 2026-05-27

Team	Date
Team Roles	Team Member
Manager: keeps track of time and makes sure everyone contributes appropriately.	
Recorder: records all answers & questions, and provides copies to team & facilitator.	
Speaker: talks to facilitator and other teams.	
Reflector: considers how the team could work and learn more effectively.	

This rubric provides a structure to record results of a FOSS Project Health Evaluation. Read the instructions before you begin to fill in Table 1.

Once you have filled in your evaluation for each of the criteria, total your scores for the project overall.

Table 1. Project Evaluation Scores

FOSS Project Name:		
Evaluation Criteria	Level (0-2)	Data, Source, and Reason
Licensing		
Technology		
Level of Activity		
Number of Contributors		
Product Size		
Issue Tracker		
New Contributor		

Community Norms		
User Base		
Total Score		

Rubric instructions

Table 1 lists each of the evaluation criteria in the FOSS Project Evaluation Rubric. For each criterion, complete the row as follows:

Data, Source, and Reason - find the information needed and record the data, the Web address(s) or other source of the data, and your reason for the score. The source information should be specific enough for someone to easily locate the data. Usually the source is a Web address.

Level - Record your score using zero to indicate that the criterion is not met at all, two to indicate that the criterion is fully met, and one for anything in between. The discussion below suggests an approach to scoring. This approach assumes that you are evaluating the project with an interest in becoming a contributor. For other evaluation purposes some of the scoring approaches should be adjusted. For some of the criteria, a score of zero will eliminate the project from consideration. The rows of the table are ordered so that criteria that are most likely to eliminate a project from consideration are nearer to the top of the table. Suggestions for scoring are:

- **Licensing** - Score 2 if the product has a free software or open source software license. Score 0 for other licenses or if the license is missing. When evaluating open source projects, a 0 here ends the evaluation.
- **Technology** - Score 2 if the programming language, frameworks, and other software technology elements are your preferred choice. Score 1 for less preferred technologies or if your preferred technologies are only a small part of the product. Score 0 if the main technologies are not suitable for your needs.
- **Level of Activity** - Score 2 if you judge all the quarters in the last year as being active. Score 1 if some of the quarters in the last year have been active. Score 0 if there have been no active quarters in the last year. Code commits are a good measure of activity and project environments such as GitLab provide a summary of this activity.
- **Number of Contributors** - Score 2 if there are 10 or more contributors. Score 1 if there are 3-10 contributors. Score 0 if there are only 1 or 2 contributors. Note that these numbers are based on the fact that most projects have only 1-2 contributors, and the score assumes you are interested in contributing to a larger, clearly established project.

If you would prefer to work with a smaller, less well-established project then adjust your scoring to reflect that.

- **Size** - Scoring for size depends on your objectives in contributing to a project. A project with little or no code will usually be scored 0. For projects that have an established code base, you might think about whether there is a "sweet spot" for code base size that you think would be ideal for your needs. If you can define that, then score projects in that range as 2. Score projects that are neither 0 or 2 as 1. If you don't know what size would be appropriate, then score anything over a reasonable minimum (suggestion: 10,000 lines) as 2.
- **Issue Tracker** - Score 2 if issues are being actively added and resolved. Score 0 if there is no issue tracker or no sign of recent activity. Score 1 if there is activity but it is very low or sporadic.
- **New Contributor** - Score 2 if there are clear instructions and welcome for new contributors. This might include information about public communication channels (IRC, Discord, etc.), mention of a community manager, "getting started" information, etc. Score 0 if there is little or no evidence of welcome or instructions for new contributors. Score 1 for anything in between.
- **Community Norms** - Score 2 if there is a documented and easy to locate code of conduct or statement of community norms that is welcoming and inclusive. Score 0 if there is any evidence of rude, unprofessional, harassing, or other undesirable behavior. Score 1 if there are no signs of poor behavior but there is no stated code of conduct or discussion of community norms.
- **User base** - Score 2 if there clearly is an active and engaged user base. Score 0 if there is little or no evidence that the product is actually being used by anyone beyond the development team. Score 1 if there is some evidence of use but not much.